> appointment with Narasimha Rao or to convey the Akalis' consent to him over the phone. He was simply unavailable so we feared something fishy was in the air.

Nayar was shocked but not surprised when the army moved into the Golden Temple on 3 June. As a member of the Punjab Group he felt defeated because Rao had entrusted them with the task of talking to the Akalis only ten days before the army moved in. Nayar had learnt from Maj. Gen. K.S. Brar, who led Operation Blue Star, that the army had been told about the assignment about a fortnight earlier. This meant that the government had already made up its mind to storm the Golden Temple even before Rao had spoken to them. Naturally, Nayar was surprised as to why Rao had hidden that fact from them. [30]

Thus ended the prolonged charade of finding a peaceful solution to the Punjab problem through negotiations with the Akalis. These prolonged rounds of talks had served the purpose of the 1 Akbar Road group and were no longer required. Instead, as per the Op-2 plan, the time had come to implement the 'final solution' to solve the Punjab problem, for which they had waited four long years.